

TOPIC 3: PETER'S FIRST SPEECH AND ITS EFFECTS

1. Peter's Boldness (Acts 2:14–41)

Peter stood with the eleven and addressed the crowd. He explained that what they heard was the fulfilment of Joel's prophecy about the Spirit. He proclaimed Jesus of Nazareth – attested by God with miracles, crucified according to God's plan, and raised from the dead. He declared that God had made this Jesus both Lord and Christ.

2. Message of Repentance

When the people were cut to the heart and asked what they should do, Peter said: "Repent and be baptized every one of you in the name of Jesus Christ for the forgiveness of your sins, and you will receive the gift of the Holy Spirit."

3. Effects

About three thousand souls received his word and were baptized. They devoted themselves to the apostles' teaching, fellowship, breaking of bread and prayers. The Church grew through clear preaching and genuine conversion.

4. Summary

Peter's Spirit-empowered sermon pointed to Jesus' death and resurrection, called for repentance and baptism, and resulted in about three thousand conversions.

End of Topic 3